

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY AND IPR

Consolidated Question Bank & Trend Analysis

22MBA23 / MBA203 | VTU Second Semester MBA | Papers Consolidated: June/July 2023, June/July 2024, June/July 2025

This document consolidates all questions from the three most recent VTU question papers for **Research Methodology and IPR**, arranged module-wise as per the official syllabus (Modules 1-6). Questions covering the same underlying concept across different years are merged into a single row and flagged as **★ REPEATED**, with all the years in which that concept appeared listed in the last column. **M** = Marks, **L** = Bloom's Taxonomy Level, **CO** = Course Outcome mapped in the original papers.

MODULE 1 | Introduction to Business Research

No	Question	M	L	CO	Year(s) Asked
1	Define Business Research / What do you understand by a research problem? Give an example. ★ REPEATED	3	L1/L 2	CO1	2024, 2025
2	What is Research? Briefly explain the different steps involved in the Research process / Describe the systematic steps involved in the process of research. ★ REPEATED	10	L2/L 3	CO1/ CO3	2023, 2024, 2025
3	Explain the different types of research.	7	L2	CO1	2024
4	Explain the features of a good research.	7	L2	CO1	2025
5	What are the possible motives for doing research in business?	7	L3	CO1	2023
6	Define management decision problem and research problem.	3	L1	CO1	2024
7	Explain the application of research in marketing, finance, human resource and production & operations management.	10	L2	CO1	2025

MODULE 2 | Business Research Design (Exploratory, Conclusive & Experimental)

No	Question	M	L	CO	Year(s) Asked
1	What is Longitudinal Research?	3	L2	CO1	2023
2	What is Exploratory Research design? / Give a difference between exploratory and conclusive research design. ★ REPEATED	3	L2/L 3	CO3/ CO4	2023, 2025
3	What are dependent variable, independent variable and extraneous variable?	3	L1	CO2	2024
4	Explain the errors affecting research design.	3	L2	CO4	2025
5	Explain the methods of exploratory research design.	7	L2	CO2	2024
6	Analyze and elaborate the conditions of choosing cross sectional and longitudinal studies in business research & justify.	7	L3	CO4	2025
7	Explain the types of descriptive research design.	7	L2	CO4	2024
8	Discuss the basic principles of Experimental designs.	7	L3	CO2	2023
9	Substantiate the different types of Informal/Formal Experimental designs / Briefly explain pre-experimental and true experimental research design / Analyze the different types of experimental research design. ★ REPEATED	10	L2/L 3	CO2/ CO3/ CO4	2023, 2024, 2025

MODULE 3 | Sampling

No	Question	M	L	CO	Year(s) Asked
1	What is a Sampling frame? / What do you mean by sample & a sample frame? ★ REPEATED	3	L2	CO1/ CO4	2023, 2025
2	Define sample and sample design.	3	L1	CO1	2024
3	List the errors in sampling.	3	L1	CO2	2024
4	Distinguish between Census and Sampling.	7	L4	CO4	2023
5	Explain the sampling process with an example.	7	L2	CO1	2025
6	Explain the different sampling methods available for researchers / Describe the probability and non-probability sampling techniques / Write your understanding on types of sampling design. ★ REPEATED	10	L2/L 3	CO3/ CO4	2023, 2024, 2025

MODULE 4 | Data Collection, Questionnaire Design & Measurement/Scaling Techniques

No	Question	M	L	CO	Year(s) Asked
1	What are Dichotomous questions?	3	L2	CO2	2023
2	What are Double-barreled questions?	3	L2	CO2	2023
3	What do you understand by data collection?	3	L3	CO2	2025
4	Define Likert scale and Semantic differential scale.	3	L1	CO2	2024
5	List the methods used for collection of primary data.	3	L1	CO3	2024
6	Explain with example the different Qualitative Techniques of Data Collection / Analyze the Qualitative research techniques with examples. ★ REPEATED	7	L3	CO2/ CO4	2023, 2025
7	What are the different sources of Secondary Data?	7	L3	CO4	2023
8	Explain the primary measurement scales adopted in business research / Discuss the primary scales of measurement with example. ★ REPEATED	7/10	L2/L 3	CO2	2023, 2024
9	Analyze the methods of data collection with an example.	7	L3	CO2	2025
10	What are the different types of observation methods that can be used by researchers in carrying out research?	10	L3	CO4	2023
11	Explain the steps involved in the questionnaire design process.	10	L3	CO2	2024
12	Explain in detail comparative and non-comparative scaling techniques.	10	L3	CO2	2025
13	Construct a questionnaire using a five-point Likert scale to measure the quality of services offered in a five-star hotel (room service, restaurant, reception, travel desk).	10	L6	CO3	2024

MODULE 5 | Data Analysis and Report Writing

No	Question	M	L	CO	Year(s) Asked
1	What is interpretation?	3	L2	CO3	2023
2	What do you understand by editing and coding?	3	L2	CO3	2025

No	Question	M	L	CO	Year(s) Asked
3	List out and briefly explain the contents of the Research report / Explain the different types of Research report / Explain the structure of the research report / Explain in detail the types of research reports with a neat structure. ★ REPEATED	7/10	L2/L3	CO3	2023, 2024, 2025
4	Explain in detail the steps involved in processing of data.	7	L2	CO3	2025
5	Describe the process involved in data analysis.	10	L3	CO3	2024

MODULE 6 | Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

No	Question	M	L	CO	Year(s) Asked
1	What is an Integrated Circuit?	3	L2	CO5	2023
2	What is intellectual property?	3	L2	CO5	2025
3	Briefly explain the characteristics of Intellectual properties.	7	L3	CO5	2023
4	Explain the different types / kinds of Intellectual Property Right(s) with examples. ★ REPEATED	7/10	L2/L3	CO5	2023, 2024, 2025
5	Write a note on TRIPS and TRIMS.	7	L2	CO4	2024
6	Elaborate your understanding of trade related investment measurement (TRIMS) and its features.	10	L4	CO5	2025
7	Write short notes on the Intellectual Property system in India.	7	L2	CO5	2024

COMPULSORY CASE STUDY | Question No. 8 (20 Marks, all 3 years)

The case study is compulsory every year and always spans Modules 1-3 (defining the research problem, recommending a research design/approach, and designing the sample). The business scenario itself changes each year, but the question *pattern* repeats closely.

2023 — ABC Company & Television Advertising Effectiveness (10,000 households, before-and-after study)

Sub-Q	Question	M	L	CO
a	Critically examine the proposed methodology.	7	L3	CO3
b	Do you think an alternative approach would be appropriate?	7	L3	CO3
c	Suggest a sampling design for the above proposed study.	6	L3	CO3

2024 — University Study on Social Media Usage & Academic Performance of Students

Sub-Q	Question	M	L	CO
a	What is the main research problem? Briefly explain.	5	L4	CO4
b	What kind of Research approach would you adopt and why?	5	L4	CO1
c	Provide the detailed Research Design and Sample Design for the study.	10	L4	CO3

2025 — New York-New Jersey Task Force & Electronic Toll Collection (ETC) Adoption Study

Sub-Q	Question	M	L	CO
a	Evaluate the problem definition. Has the problem been defined adequately?	10	L3	CO4
b	What type of research design would you recommend for this project?	10	L6	CO4

MOST REPEATED QUESTIONS (Asked in All 3 Years — 2023, 2024 & 2025)

- ★ [Module 1] The research process / systematic steps involved in research (10 Marks)
- ★ [Module 2] Types of experimental research design (formal/informal, pre-experimental, true-experimental, quasi-experimental) (10 Marks)
- ★ [Module 3] Sampling methods / probability & non-probability sampling techniques / types of sampling design (10 Marks)
- ★ [Module 5] Types and structure of the research report (7-10 Marks)
- ★ [Module 6] Types / kinds of Intellectual Property Rights (7-10 Marks)
- ★ [Q.8 (Compulsory)] Case study requiring: defining the research problem + recommending a research design + designing the sample (20 Marks)

Repeated in 2 of the Last 3 Years

- [Module 2] Exploratory research design (definition / difference from conclusive design) (3-7 Marks; 2023, 2025)
- [Module 3] Sampling frame / sample & sample frame (3 Marks; 2023, 2025)
- [Module 4] Qualitative techniques of data collection (7 Marks; 2023, 2025)
- [Module 4] Primary measurement scales in business research (7-10 Marks; 2023, 2024)

PROBABLE QUESTIONS FOR THE UPCOMING EXAMINATION

Based on the 3-year repetition pattern above, these topics carry the highest probability of being asked again. This is an educated estimate from historical trends only — it is not an official prediction and should be used to prioritize revision, not replace full syllabus coverage.

Module	Likely Topics	Probability
Module 1	Meaning of Business/Management research problem; steps in the research process; motives/features of good research	High
Module 2	Types of experimental research designs (pre-experimental, true, quasi); exploratory vs conclusive design	Very High
Module 3	Probability vs non-probability sampling techniques; sample frame; errors in sampling	Very High
Module 4	Questionnaire design steps; comparative/non-comparative scaling; Likert & semantic differential scales	High
Module 5	Structure/types of a research report; steps in data processing (editing, coding, tabulation)	Very High
Module 6	Kinds of Intellectual Property Rights; TRIPS/TRIMS; IPR system in India	Very High
Q.8 (Compulsory)	A new business case scenario asking you to: (a) define the research problem, (b) recommend/justify a research design or approach, (c) design the sampling plan	Certain (compulsory every year)